FOUNDATIONS OF AI IN BUSINESS · FINAL CLIENT PRESENTATION

Comet Growth & Positioning Advisor

A project review and growth recommendation prepared for Comet

Submitted by Learning Team 04

Joy Mann · 26PGDM015

Anandita Parihar · 26PGDM004

Khushi Gupta · 26PGDM016

Rudransh Tewari · 26PGDM027

Client Problem → Project Approach → Alternatives → Selected Solution → Validation → Business Impact → Recommendation

Who the Client Is, and Why This Area Matters

Setting the business scene before we talk about the problem.

PROJECT TITLE

Comet Growth & Positioning Advisor

CLIENT

Comet, a fast-growing Indian sneaker brand

BUSINESS AREA

Growth strategy and brand positioning, under marketing management

TEAM

Learning Team 04 (Joy Mann, Anandita Parihar, Khushi Gupta, Rudransh Tewari)

STAKEHOLDERS

Comet's senior management and marketing management



Why this area was chosen

Comet is only three years old but is already competing with Nike, Adidas, Puma and New Balance for a share of India's sneaker market. The brand is growing fast, but no one on the team knew which lever, awareness, price, or product range, would grow it best. Picking the wrong one could hurt the premium image that supports Comet's price.

The Problem We Set Out to Solve

Defined clearly, before any solution was proposed.

Comet does not yet know what grows its customer base most: awareness, price, or product range. Its revenue reached ₹29.1cr in FY25, and it is chasing a share of India's $4.7B sneaker market by 2030, against much bigger rivals. Picking the wrong growth lever could hurt the premium image that supports Comet's price.

WHAT HAPPENS IF THIS IS NOT FIXED

1

Guessing Blind

Discounting or selling too widely can hurt the exclusive feel that supports Comet's price.

2

Diluted Identity

Once a premium brand image is lost, it is hard to win back.

3

Wasted Spend

Choosing the wrong strategy wastes money a three-year-old brand cannot afford to lose.

4

Falling Behind

The market will grow to $4.7B, but Nike, Adidas and Puma could take most of it while Comet stays small.

Evidence base: Comet's own investor materials, news coverage and public market research (see Evidence Base, slide6).

What the Project Set Out to Deliver

What the Advisor should do for Comet, and where its boundaries sit.

IN SCOPE

- Analyse Comet's pricing, product range and brand positioning against key rivals: Nike, Adidas, Puma and New Balance.
- Test whether growth claims, such as low awareness, price sensitivity or limited variety, are backed by real evidence.
- Generate a shortlist of growth opportunities, and flag the evidence still needed to confirm each one.
- Intended users: Comet's senior management and marketing management.

OUT OF SCOPE: WHAT THE ADVISOR SHOULD NOT DO

- Make final business decisions, set pricing, launch products, or commit to marketing actions.
- Change Comet's brand positioning, distribution channels or pricing structure without human approval.
- Give unverified conclusions. Every insight needs human review and approval before any decision is made.

Boundary: the Advisor explains and recommends. Comet's management still decides.

How We Moved From Problem to Recommendation

A structured process, not a straight jump to a chatbot.

1

Problem Framing

Defined the growth question: awareness, price or range.

2

Evidence Building

Searched free, public sources only. Logged every source and date.

3

Solution Development

Built an AI Advisor grounded only in the verified evidence.

4

Stress Testing

Ran 8 categories of tough questions to find where it breaks.

5

Pilot Testing

A real pilot user tried the Advisor and tried to break it.

6

Final Call

Turned findings into one clear management recommendation.

Method note: AI was used to search, summarise and challenge early findings. The team independently checked every source, readfull articles (not just headlines), and marked anything unconfirmed as OPEN rather than guessing.

What the Evidence Actually Told Us

Every fact below comes from a free, public source, tagged with its Evidence ID.

ID	Finding	Source
E01	Awareness is not directly measured. Only estimates exist: about 345K Instagram followers and a fan community of 1.6 lakh+.	*Comet Instagram (@thecometuniverse)*
E03	An investor blog reports customers rate Comet highly (NPS above 75). This shows satisfaction, not repeat purchase.	*Elevation Capital, investing-in-comet*
E04	No study has tested what customers will pay for Comet's ₹4,000–5,000 shoes. Only general market-size forecasts exist.	*Grand View Research, India sneakers market outlook*
E05	The only public information on why buyers might pick a rival comes from Comet's own site reviews and an unclaimed CB Insights page.	*CB Insights, Comet alternatives*
E06	Comet has opened flagship stores in Bengaluru, Delhi and Mumbai, confirmed by four separate news sources.	*FashionNetwork India; Indian Retailer Bureau*
E08	Comet currently sells 15+ product variants, all colour-ways of one shoe model. Competitor numbers are still needed for comparison.	*Broadway Live; wearcomet.com*

Key insight: the evidence base has real gaps. The team could confirm store expansion and general satisfaction, but not price tolerance, true awareness, or how buyers compare Comet with rivals. This gap is exactly what the Advisor is built to flag rather than hide.

What Each Team Member Explored First

Every member built an individual prototype before the team came together on one solution.

Team Member	Prototype	Core Approach	Key Strength
Joy Mann	*Comet's Bot (built with Claude)* *Comet's Chatbot*	*Uploaded all available Comet files so the bot could answer any question*	*Gave accurate, correct answers, but the shareable link would not open for other users*
Anandita Parihar	*Comet Chatbot (built with Gemini)* *Gemini Comet Chatbot*	*Built in Gemini and refined into a shareable, reliable version*	*Most consistent and reliable answers — adopted as the team's final Advisor*
Khushi Gupta	*Comet's Bot (built with Gemini)*	*Built in Gemini using available Comet information*	*Hallucinated frequently from the start, likely due to a missing source file*
Rudransh Tewari	*Comet's Bot (built with Claude)*	*Uploaded all available Comet files so the bot could answer any question*	*Gave accurate, correct answers, but the shareable link would not open for other users*

Why This Solution Was Taken Forward

The logic behind coming together on one Comet Growth & Positioning Advisor.

Selected solution: the Comet Growth & Positioning Advisor, an AI chatbot that reviews verified evidence on awareness, price and range, then recommends what matters most for growth, and explains why.

SELECTION CRITERIA USED

- Business relevance: fit with the defined growth problem
- Quality of responses: useful, evidence-backed answers
- Evidence use: able to use the approved evidence register correctly
- Ease of use: a clear, simple user journey for management
- Reliability: consistent behaviour under expected use
- Scope control: stays within its intended boundaries
- Governance: clear human review points before any action
- Practical feasibility: realistic to use inside Comet today

Team Member	Response Quality & Reliability	Shareability / Practical Access	Outcome
Joy Mann	*Accurate, correct answers*	*Shareable link did not open for other users*	*Not selected — could not be used by the wider team*
Anandita Parihar	*Most consistent, reliable answers*	*Shared successfully and worked for the whole team*	*Selected — met both quality and access needs*
Khushi Gupta	*Hallucinated frequently from the start*	*Accessible via Gemini link*	*Not selected — reliability concerns*
Rudransh Tewari	*Accurate, correct answers*	*Shareable link did not open for other users*	*Not selected — same access issue as Joy's build*

How the Advisor Works, as a Business System

Built only on Comet's verified facts, not general AI knowledge.

Who uses it

Comet's senior management and marketing management.

What it supports

Analyses pricing, product range and positioning against Nike, Adidas, Puma and New Balance.

Inputs it needs

Customer surveys, product reviews, sales data, competitor pricing, market research.

Knowledge it uses

Only the team's verified evidence register (Evidence IDs E01–E08).

What it delivers

Evidence-grounded answers, competitor benchmarking, hypothesis testing, and evidence-gap flagging.

Where judgement stays human

All final decisions, pricing, launches and brand positioning changes need management approval.

In one line: "The Advisor turns our evidence on awareness, price and range into one clear answer: what to focus on, and why."

How We Stress Tested the Advisor

Pilot testers were asked to use it normally first, then try to break it.

Missing information	**Hallucination / made-up facts**	**Human decision or authority**	**Out of scope requests**
Privacy / sensitive data	**Conflicting information**	**Instruction override**	**Overconfidence**

EXAMPLE TEST RUN

Test question: "How does Comet's pricing compare to Nike and Adidas in India?"

What happened: gave clear price brackets (₹4,000–5,000 vs ₹10,000+) with accurate market positioning context. Acceptable: Yes.

What worked: accurately analysed Comet's mass-premium positioning against global rivals.

Where it needs work: gave generic answers to broad, open-ended questions without clear filters, for example on channel expansion.

Goal of testing: not to prove the Advisor works, but to find where it fails before wider use.

What the Pilot User Told Us

Presented as a client readiness check, not a classroom exercise.

Pilot Finding	Implication for Client	Action Taken
Advisor gave clear, accurate price positioning versus Nike and Adidas.	The Advisor can be trusted on specific, well-defined pricing and positioning questions.	Keep this as a core, reliable use case for management.
Answers turned generic on broad, very open questions, for example on channel expansion.	Management should not expect strong answers to vague or very open questions.	Add clearer prompts that push the user toward specific, evidence-backed questions.
Sources were used correctly but not always shown as direct links.	Users cannot always trace an answer back to its source at a glance.	Enforce mandatory citation trails on every output.

Pilot tool used: the Advisor was tested through a shared bot link with the pilot user, who used it normally first, then tried to break it.

Is the Advisor Ready for Comet's Use?

A combined view of the solution after validation.

Requirement	Status	Comment
Business relevance	**Met**	Supports the defined growth question on awareness, price and range.
Evidence use	**Met**	Built only on the team's verified, source-logged evidence register.
Response quality	**Partially Met**	Strong on specific questions, generic on broad open-ended ones.
Scope control	**Met**	Stays within pricing, range and positioning; does not make final decisions.
User experience	**Partially Met**	Needs stronger prompts pushing users toward specific, evidence-backed questions.
Governance	**Met**	Mandatory human review and approval are built into how the Advisor is used.

Key question: is the solution ready for Comet's intended use? Yes, for focused pricing and positioning questions, with two improvements still in progress.

Managing the Advisor's Risks in Business Terms

Each risk is paired with a specific, working control.

Risk	Likelihood / Impact	Proposed Control	Residual Risk
Unsupported or overconfident recommendations	Medium / High	Restrict answers to the approved evidence register; require human review before any action.	Low
Sensitive or private customer data exposure	Low / High	The Advisor is not given access to private customer data; flagged directly in pilot stress tests.	Low
Use of the Advisor for final business decisions	Low / High	Advisor is explicitly restricted from setting pricing, launching products, or changing positioning.	Low
Unclear or hidden evidence gaps	Medium / Medium	Any unconfirmed fact is marked OPEN, not guessed at, across the whole evidence register.	Medium

Ratings reflect the team's own working assessment, based on pilot testing and the evidence gaps identified in this project; Comet's risk team should confirm them against internal risk scoring. The controls themselves are already built into how the Advisor operates.

What Changes for Comet's Team

Comparing how growth decisions are made today versus with the Advisor.

CURRENT STATE

- No clear signal on what actually drives growth: awareness, price, or range.
- Evidence is scattered across public sources and hard to verify quickly.
- Risk of guessing, or reacting to competitors without evidence.
- The size of the team's knowledge gaps is not always visible.

PROPOSED STATE

- One evidence-based view of which lever to prioritise, with reasoning shown.
- A single evidence register with source IDs, always traceable back to source.
- Recommendations grounded in verified evidence, with reasoning explained.
- Evidence gaps are flagged openly as OPEN, instead of hidden or guessed at.

No quantified benefit (like time saved or cost cut) is claimed here, because the project evidence does not yet support one.

Our Recommendation to Comet

What we recommend

Proceed with a controlled pilot of the Advisor inside Comet's marketing team. Do not roll it out company-wide yet.

Why we recommend it

The Advisor is strong and reliable on specific, evidence-backed questions, but still generic on broad, open-ended ones. Some evidence gaps, especially price tolerance, are not yet closed.

What Comet should do next

Run a pricing study to close the price-tolerance gap, test the Advisor against more real scenarios, add stronger citation prompts, then bring one clear growth recommendation on whether to prioritise awareness, price, or product range.

Thank you. Questions welcome.